



M03: Making up new words

1. Pre-watching brainstorming:

1. With your table group, discuss potential reasons why new words are created or taken from another language. Use examples such as *kindergarten*, *schadenfreude*, *Brunch* (breakfast + lunch) or *Handy*.
2. Why might people use a word from another language in addition to a word that already exists, such as (in German) *Rendezvous* vs. *Date* vs. *Verabredung*?

2. While-watching note-taking: Watch the TED talk [“Go ahead, make up new words!”](#) by Erin McKean. Find the terms and short descriptions for the word-formation techniques mentioned in the video:

Example	Name of the process	Description: How the process works
ninja	borrowing	stealing the word
duckface	compounding	duckface = duck + face (not only possible with two nouns but also adjectives and verbs)
brunch	blend	brunch = breakfast + lunsh
to friend	functional shift (also called 'conversion')	from (the) Friend to the Verb to friend
to burgle	back formation	from (the) Burgler to the Verb to burgle
OMG	bodo	From Oh my God ---> OMG

3. Post-watching activity:

1. Find at least two further example for each of the word-formation processes in addition to the examples given in the video.
2. Make up at least one new word using every word-formation process from the video. It might be useful to think back to moments when you were struggling to find the right word (in an exam, in class, with friends, ...).
3. Discuss your results with your table group, discuss potential mistakes you or they might have made, and add their examples to your list.

Further examples

borrowing - Kindergarten
borrowing - caramel

compounding - catfish
compounding - dogface

blend - Microsoft
blend - Milka

functional shift - walk
functional shift - rain

Back Formation - argue
Back Formation - edit

Bodo - Nasa
Bodo - IBM

Own creations

dogface

Examples from other group members